



NZDMA GOLD AWARD

Say It Tika

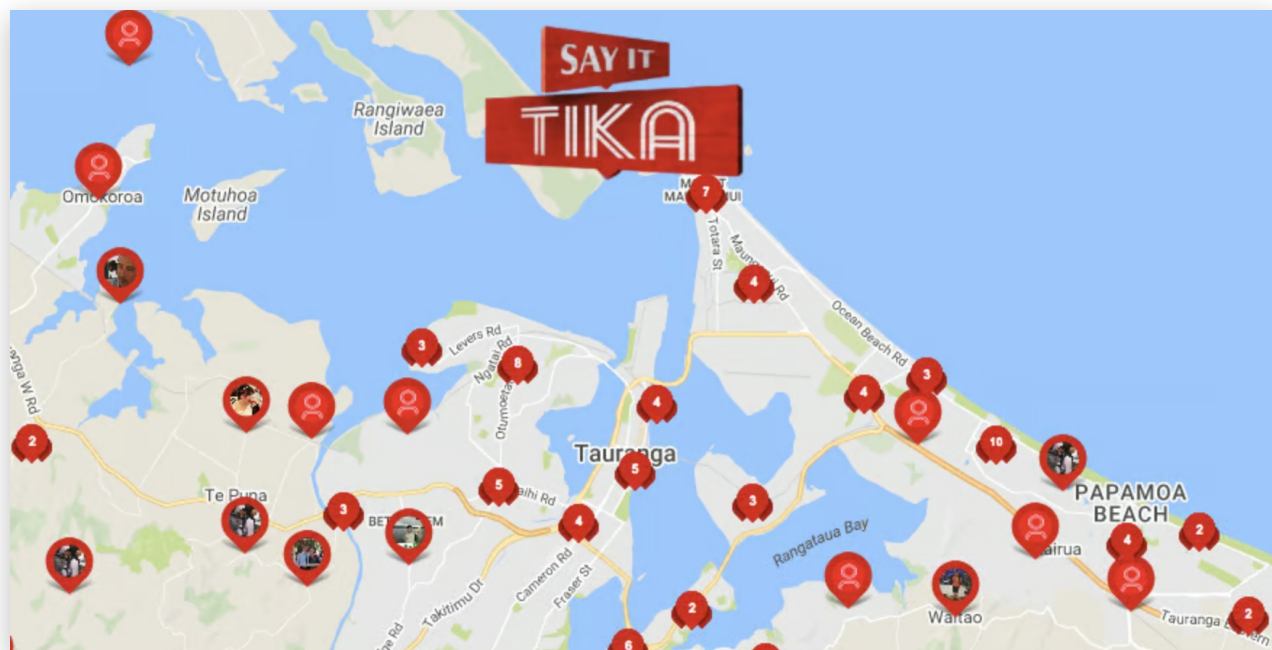
Turning a customer campaign into a Google Maps product change

Vodafone New Zealand × Google Maps × Te Taura Whiri i te Reo Māori

Case study | Matthew Batcheldor | Google New Zealand

Campaign launched 2017. Google Maps' new NZ voice with improved te reo Māori pronunciation launched in 2026.

A brand campaign aimed at fixing a real product problem



THE PROBLEM

Google Maps was mispronouncing te reo Māori place names.

Vodafone and FCB created Say It Tika: a public platform where New Zealanders could flag incorrect pronunciations and build a priority list for correction.

8,900+

place names pinned
in the first
campaign wave

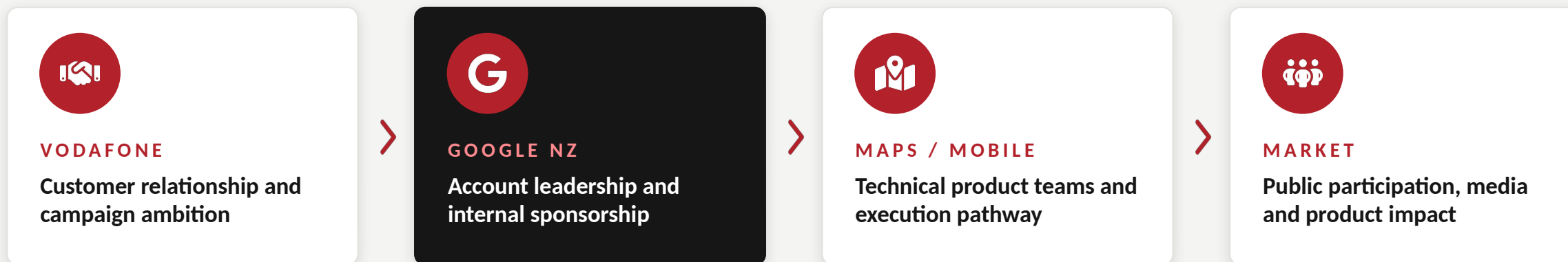
870K

video views

13K

Facebook shares

The commercial lead became the internal bridge to product



What I did

- ✓ Led the Vodafone relationship at Google New Zealand.
- ✓ Helped translate a customer and cultural objective into an executable product workstream.
- ✓ Progressed the campaign internally with Google's mobile and Maps technical teams.
- ✓ Supported the initiative with Google media activity, coordinating across customer, agency and internal stakeholders.

Real participation, real recognition

67,000+

pins placed in 14 days

~10,000

place names identified

500

reported as perfected by 2018

Recognition



NZDMA Gold Industry Gold, NZ Direct Marketing Awards



Māori Language Commission Special recognition, 2017



One Show 2018 Bronze Pencil, Branded Social Post / Single



One Show 2018 Merit, Social Engagement / Community Building



Cannes Lions 2018 Shortlist, Brand Experience & Activation

 **Matthew Batchelor**
Commercial Growth & Strategic Partnerships Leader | Enterprise GTM | Partner Ecosystems | AI-Enabled Growth | ex-Google

NZDMA Gold Award — Vodafone “Say It Tika” 
Issued by The NZ Direct Marketing Awards (NZDM) · Jan 2017

 Associated with Google

• Won 2017 Industry Gold NZDM award for supporting work on Vodafone 'Say it Tika' campaign to improve Maori Te Reo language and regional place names on Google Maps.

<https://nzdmawards.co.nz/winnerscat/say-it-tika-say-it-right/>

<https://www.adsoftheworld.com/campaigns/say-it-tika>

Google Industry Gold Award - Samsung & Starcom Video Effectiveness 
Issued by Google · Jan 2016

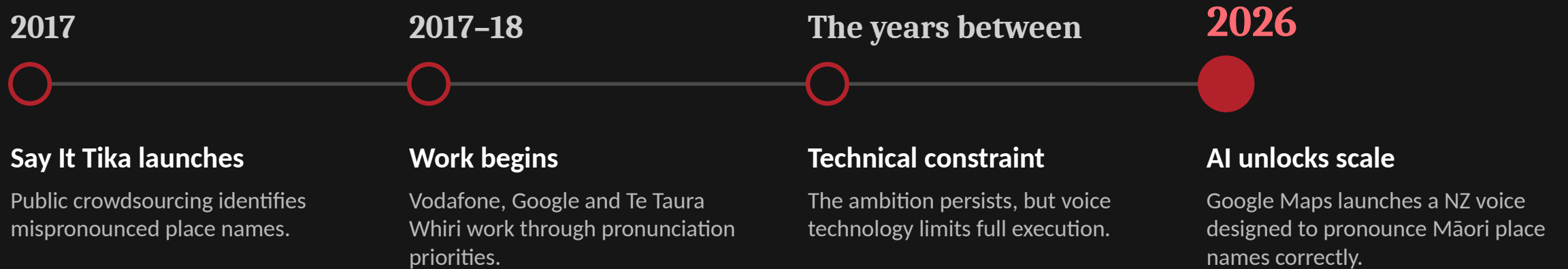
 Associated with Google

Recognised for innovative video-effectiveness work with Samsung and Starcom comparing advertising across YouTube and Facebook.

The study examined the fundamentally different video experiences and measurement approaches across the two platforms, including view definitions and the impact of user attention and sound, helping demonstrate how platform context should inform video investment and measurement.

As listed on my LinkedIn profile

2017 to 2026: the product promise finally lands at scale



“ *Years-long partnership and deep collaboration*

Google NZ's 2026 description of the work with Te Taura Whiri

More than an advertising account



STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP

Moved beyond media sales into a customer, platform and community partnership.



INTERNAL INFLUENCE

Worked with Google product stakeholders to progress a market-specific customer need.



PRODUCT + GTM

Connected brand ambition, technical execution, public participation and media support.



LONG-TERM IMPACT

The underlying problem stayed important enough to become a scaled Maps capability in 2026.

Enterprise account leadership

Strategic partnerships

Cross-functional influence

Customer-led product change

Media + technology